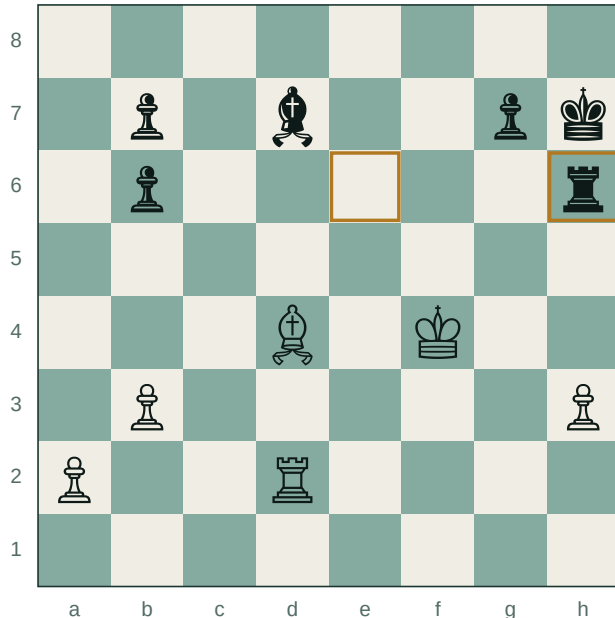


Discovered attacks: White, move 40

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 39...Rh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. Bxg7 Kxg7 41. Rxd7+

40.Bxg7 The bishop captures the pawn on g7. The changed line means the rook on d2 attacks the bishop on d7. Recorded reply: **40...Kxg7**.

41.Rxd7+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d7. Check for tactical protection.